

STAT 20000: Elementary Statistics

Winter 2026

University of Chicago — Department of Statistics

Course Logistics

Instructor: Anirban Chatterjee (anirbanc@uchicago.edu)
Office Hours: TBA
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Course Timings: MWF 9:30–10:20 AM
Course Webpage: <https://anirbanc96.github.io/stat-2000-spring-2026/>

Communication Policy

- All announcements will be made in the course [Canvas](#) page.
- To ensure a timely response, please include [STAT 20000] at the beginning of the subject line for all course-related emails. Emails without this tag may experience delays.

Prerequisites & Enrollment (Should I take STAT 20000?)

- **No Prerequisite:** STAT 20000/20010 has no prerequisites.
- **Intended Audience:** Non-quantitative students with no intention to take STAT 22000/23400 or further STAT courses in the future.
- **General Education:** This is a General Education course, not a “warm-up” for STAT 22000 or 23400. You do **not** need to take this before those higher-level courses.
- **AP Statistics:** If you have taken AP Statistics, you should start from STAT 22000 or higher. STAT 20000 is lower than AP Statistics.
- **Credit Restrictions:** Do **NOT** take both STAT 20000 and 20010; only one may count toward the 42 credits required for graduation.
- **Math Sciences Requirement:**
 - STAT 20000, 20010, 22000 meets one of the [general education requirements in the mathematical sciences](#).
 - At most one of STAT 20000, 20010 and STAT 22000, can count toward the general education requirements in the mathematical sciences.
- **More Info:** <http://www.stat.uchicago.edu/~yibi/IntroStat/>

Course Goals & Topics

Stat 20000 introduces fundamental topics using a conceptual approach with less emphasis on formal mathematics. Topics include:

- Design of experiments and Descriptive statistics
- Correlation and simple linear regression
- Chance variability (Central Limit Theorem) and Chance models
- Sampling and Tests of significance

Required Materials

- **Textbook:** *Statistics*, 4th edition, by D. Freedman, R. Pisani & R. Purves. (Hard copy or ebook). We will cover chapters 1–6, 8–11, 13–14, 16–21, 23, 26–27, and potentially 28.
- **Calculator:** A simple calculator with square root ($\sqrt{x}$) and square (x^2) keys is required for all homework and exams.

Grade Components

- **Homework (30%):** 1 assignment per week. Approximately 7–8 assignments. The lowest score is dropped.
- **Midterm (30%):** Friday, 4/24, in class.
- **Final Exam (40%):** In-person, per the Registrar's Office schedule. No early finals.

Homework Policies

Deadlines & Grace Period

- **No late homework is accepted.**
- We provide a **2-hour grace period** for technical issues. Submissions 2:01 hours late will not be graded.
- We drop the lowest homework score to account for missed assignments.

Work Quality

- **Show your work:** A final number alone is not an acceptable answer. Work must be coherent and legible. We may deduct points for poorly presented answers.
- **Conceptual Questions:** For conceptual questions, a well-articulated explanation with properly supported reasons would earn more points than answers that reach the same conclusion without proper support.
- **Corrections:** You may submit updated versions before the deadline; we will grade the last pdf submitted before the deadline or within the 2-hour grace period.
- **Gradescope:** All homework submissions are through [Gradescope](#). You must match pages with questions. We do not give credit for incorrect files or missing pages.

- Please submit homework at <https://www.gradescope.com/courses/1284418>.
- Refer to [Guidelines on Submitting HW on Gradescope](#) for guidance.

Collaboration & AI Policy

- **Collaboration:** Discussing concepts is encouraged, but you must make an honest 15-minute attempt alone first. You should acknowledge any significant help or ideas you receive from others in your paper.
 - If a friend asks, "How did you do this part?" then...
 - * your response should be "What have you done so far?" and "Where are you stuck?"
 - * your response should never be, "Here is how I did it."
- **Independence: Final write-ups and computer work (codes/graphs)** must be done independently. Do NOT share your computer work (codes, graphs) with other students.
- **Academic Integrity:** Don't send your homework to other students. **Showing your homework to others or copying from others/past HW or exam solutions is prohibited** and counts as **academic dishonesty**. **Any suspected instances of cheating or plagiarism will be formally reported to the College for official review, regardless of the scale of the incident.**
- **AI Policy:** You can use AI to help you study. For example, you can ask AI to explain a concept or a technique, test you on a specific topic, and do grammar checking. Your goal is to understand the material and master the skill, not simply to get the correct answer. Keep in mind that you don't have access to AI during the midterm and the final exam, as they are done in person.

Regrade Requests

Check the accuracy of your grading promptly. If you find a mistake or believe you deserve partial credit, submit a request via Gradescope. Tutorial: [How to send a Regrade Request](#) (4 mins).